Nikhil Pradhan

Digital Transformation | Business Intelligence & Reporting | Operations Systems

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Languages: English (native), Hindi, Nepali, French (A2, working toward B1)
Work rights: Belgium and the Netherlands, no employer sponsorship required

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Digital transformation professional who takes organisations off paper and spreadsheets and onto systems the people there can actually run. Digitised four hospitality SMEs end to end, all four still live 2 to 3 years on, and owns the **training records, compliance reporting and curriculum** for a World Bank-financed MSME programme, **audited by KPMG and the Government of India with zero findings**. Engineer by training (B.Tech, VLSI); Erasmus Mundus MBA, Impact Entrepreneurship. Founder of ApiCare, selected by the Government of India (Dept. of Commerce & Industries, Sikkim) as private-sector training partner.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **4** SME digitisations delivered end to end, all still live 2 to 3 years on, producing **3M+** views, **300K+** clicks and **EUR 135,000+** in bookings
- **Zero** findings in every RAMP review cycle under KPMG audit, across **125+** participants trained and tracked
- **EUR 22,000+** annual revenue from a market built from zero, and **USD 20,000+** in non-dilutive funding secured

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder; Operations, Product and Strategy

ApiCare Organic Pvt. Ltd, Sikkim, India | Jan 2021 - Present

- Built and runs every system the business operates on: **production, supply chain, training and go-to-market**. Selected tooling the team could maintain without him
- Rebuilt the production model after diagnosing why the original failed: native colonies absconded from a single 200 to 300-hive farm, so moved to village clusters of 20 to 50 hives; training villagers to run it opened the government partnership
- Mobilised 150+ smallholder beekeepers across three Himalayan districts into one supply chain, owning recruitment, training, quality control and offtake
- Built D2C and export channels, pricing, inventory and logistics from zero, reaching EUR 22,000+ annual revenue; chose direct distribution into European specialty retail over an importer to hold margin; preparing EU entry via Eurofins certification
- Set pricing to fix the farmer's cash problem, not just the margin: INR 1,000 to 1,100/kg cash on collection, roughly 3x the INR 350/kg bulk-buyer rate, absorbing spoilage and payment-delay risk
- Secured USD 20,000+ in non-dilutive funding (Visible Fund, One Collective); 100% accurate disbursement reporting

Training Partner, World Bank-financed MSME Programme (RAMP)

Government of India (Dept. of Commerce & Industries, Sikkim), Contract | Mar 2025 - Present

- Owns the training record system end to end on the state's **Sikkim Entrepreneurs Connect** platform, covering demand planning, registrations, attendance, certification and outcomes, and produces the **compliance reports** the department and its auditors review
- Designed the entrepreneurship and food-processing curriculum himself; auditor-approved, delivered personally and through a Master Trainer he developed (NI-MSME-certified)
- Trained 125+ participants across four village clusters; coordinated compliance between department secretaries and **KPMG, with zero findings in every review cycle**
- Secured and leading a EUR 29,000 (INR 32 lakh) second-round work order across five locations (Jul 2026 to Mar 2027): curriculum, scheduling, participant tracking and reporting

Digital Product Strategist and Business Development Lead

Independent Consultant, Hospitality SMEs, Sikkim, India | Mar 2023 - Jul 2025

- Took four Himalayan resorts from undiscoverable to bookable (**websites, eZee channel manager, OTA onboarding, booking automation**), producing 3M+ views, 300K+ clicks and EUR 135,000+ in cumulative bookings in one year
- Chose tooling the owners could run themselves despite weak connectivity; **all four platforms are still live 2 to 3 years on**

Erasmus+ Trainee, Content and Digital Production
Hotel Poreč (HP Duga), Poreč, Istria, Croatia | Jun 2026 - Jul 2026

- Co-led a two-engine (prestige and reach) destination content strategy for international markets, built around the Parenzana cycling trail and the hill towns of Motovun, Grožnjan and Završje

PROJECTS

FarmLedger: Traceability and Producer Credit Records Platform | MBA thesis platform, in build, live prototype

- Designed QR-linked producer verification (GPS, certification status, AI-assisted quality grade, plain-English audit trail) on **Azure AI Foundry**
- Designed the credit logic on one principle, digitise the transaction, not the farmer: multimodal AI turns a producer's recorded trades into a credit profile a lender can underwrite against
- Published case studies: nikhilpradhan.in/case-studies

EDUCATION

Erasmus Mundus Joint Master's, MBA in Impact Entrepreneurship | Sep 2025 - Present
ZSEM (Croatia), ISM (Lithuania), HEC Liège (Belgium). Top 1% global scholarship. Thesis: FarmLedger

B.Tech, Electronics and Communication Engineering (VLSI) | 2019
Sikkim Manipal Institute of Technology, India

SKILLS

Data and analysis: Python, SQL, Advanced Excel, performance dashboards, financial modelling, Google Analytics, KPI tracking

Digital and AI: Azure AI Foundry, OpenAI API, prompt engineering, WordPress, eZee channel manager, Notion, Jira, Asana, Agile, Lean, DaVinci Resolve, Lightroom

Delivery and operations: Programme delivery, compliance and audit, training records and reporting, capacity building, public-private partnership, stakeholder management, supply chain design, grant management

CERTIFICATIONS

- Training of Trainers (ToT) in Entrepreneurship and Skill Development, NI-MSME, Ministry of MSME, Government of India, Jul 2025
- Responsible AI: Ethics, Innovation and Practice
- Capsim Capstone 2.0 and MARKSTRAT business simulations